

How Norges Bank Communicates

A paragraph-level analysis of communicative
functions and topics across 80 recent documents

Project Overview

What this project does

This project provides a descriptive, paragraph-level analysis of how Norges Bank used language in its most recent English-language speeches and press releases.

Each paragraph was classified along two dimensions: its communicative function (what the text is doing) and its substantive topic (what it is about).

Results should be read as descriptive patterns within a bounded corpus and not as evidence of effects on audiences.

Source: Norges Bank — norges-bank.no · Analysis: paragraph-level text classification

80

Documents analysed

40 speeches · 40 press releases

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Unit of analysis

Paragraph level

2

Dimensions coded

Function · Topic

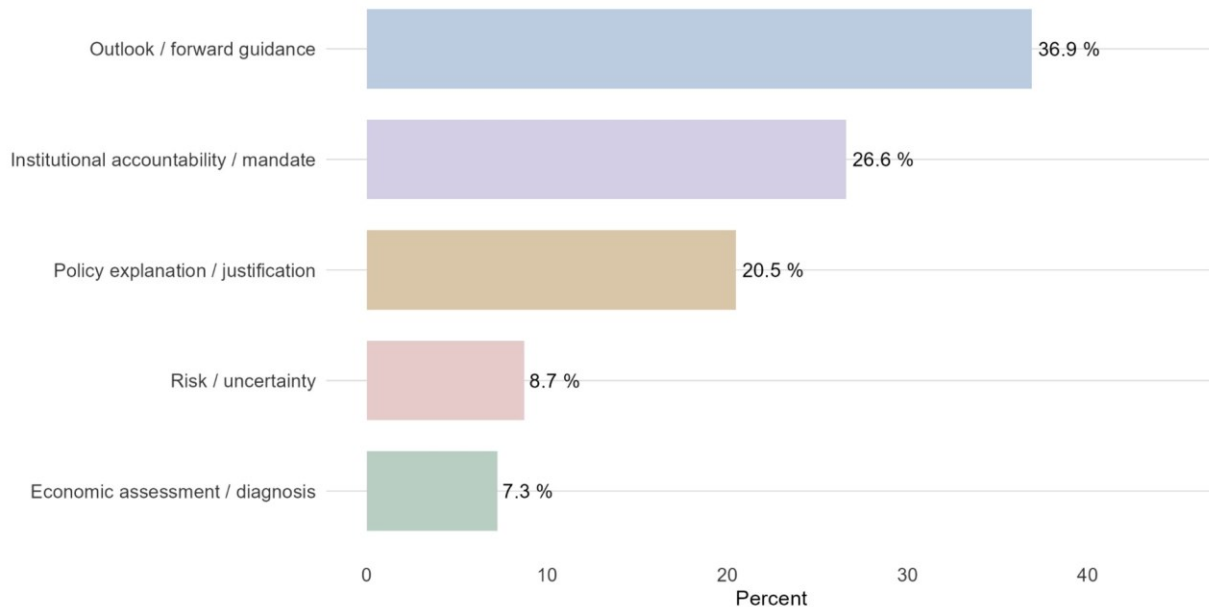
Apr
2026

Date collected

norges-bank.no

Communicative Functions

Communicative function overall



36.9%

Outlook / forward guidance

The dominant function — Norges Bank strongly orients audiences toward future developments.

26.6%

Institutional accountability

Mandate and institutional reasoning form a substantial share of communication.

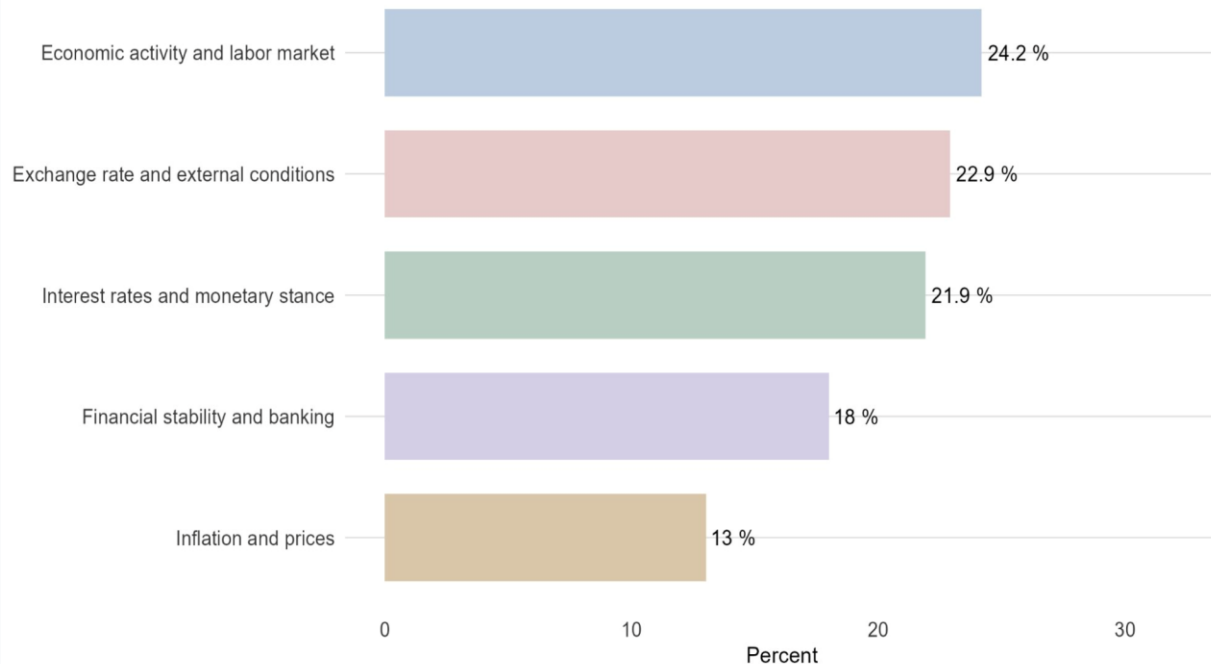
7.3%

Economic assessment

Pure diagnostic content is relatively rare — context is often embedded in forward guidance.

Substantive Topics

Main topic overall



Key finding

Inflation alone does not dominate

The topic distribution is notably broad. Inflation and prices account for only 13% of paragraphs — well below economic activity (24.2%), exchange rate and external conditions (22.9%), and interest rate stance (21.9%).

This suggests Norges Bank places rate decisions in a wide economic narrative rather than centering on price stability alone.

Function and Topic

Link between function and topic

Institutional accountability / mandate	2.1	17.1	15.8	34.8	30.2
Risk / uncertainty	6.5	4.1	21.1	41.5	26.8
Outlook / forward guidance	18.1	29.3	32.9	14.1	5.6
Policy explanation / justification	16.7	29.5	13.2	17	23.6
Economic assessment / diagnosis	24.5	2	45.1	18.6	9.8

Inflation and prices

Interest rates and monetary stance

Economic activity and labor market

Exchange rate and external conditions

Financial stability and banking

Percent

10 20 30 40

45.1%

of economic assessment paragraphs are about economic activity & labor market

41.5%

of risk/uncertainty paragraphs concern exchange rate and external conditions

32.9%

of outlook/forward guidance paragraphs focus on economic activity

Row percentages — each function sums to 100% · n = 80 documents

Three takeaways

01

Forward-looking, not diagnostic

Outlook and forward guidance (36.9%) dominated Norges Bank communication in this corpus, while economic assessment was rare (7.3%). The bank orients audiences toward what comes next rather than explaining current conditions.

02

Broad economic narrative

The topic mix was spread across five areas: activity and labor market (24.2%), exchange rate (22.9%), interest rates (21.9%), financial stability (18.0%), and inflation (13.0%). Norges Bank does not center its communication on inflation alone.

03

Functions concentrate on specific topics

Economic assessment clusters around labor-market content (45.1%), while risk and uncertainty discourse is most linked to exchange-rate topics (41.5%). These patterns reflect the institutional logic of each communicative act.